CONCRETE TO CALM – CASE STUDY

By Sujan Pokhrel

A. Project Overview

This project explores the contrast between dense urban structures and the calming effect of nature. The goal was to visually communicate how even small integrations of greenery can transform emotional well-being in urban environments. The poster series expresses a transition from 'concrete' to 'calm' using abstraction and Swiss Style principles.

B. Research Process

Research included environmental psychology, effects of green spaces on emotional health, and visual studies in abstraction, Bauhaus, and the International Typographic Style. Works by Müller-Brockmann and modern grid-based designers informed structure, clarity, and hierarchy in the final concept.

C. Key Insights

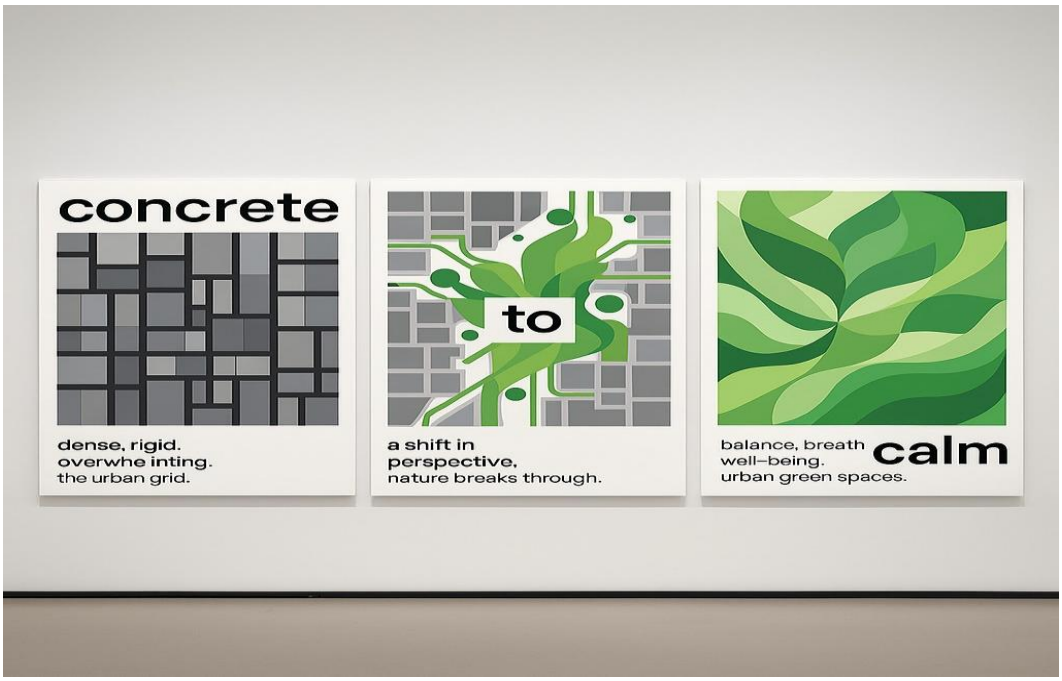
• Rigid structures evoke pressure and density.
• Organic forms communicate relief and openness.
• Color temperature strongly affects emotional perception.
• Grid systems can symbolize urban constraint while also enabling controlled composition.

D. Design Rationale (Swiss Style Framework)

Grid: Used to echo the rigidity of urban planning.
Asymmetry: Directs movement from chaos to calm.
Typography: Clean sans-serif type ensures clarity.
Color Strategy: Greys represent concrete; greens represent nature and renewal.
Abstraction: Emotional states depicted through simplified shapes rather than literal scenes.

E. Development & Iteration

The process involved multiple rounds of composition tests, color refinement, and typographic restructuring. Below is the updated final artwork used in the last refinement stage.


concrete
dense, rigid.
overwhe inting.
the urban grid.
to
a shift in
perspective,
nature breaks through.
balance, breath
well-being.
urban green spaces.
calm

F. Final Outcome

The final poster series clearly communicates the transformation from structured urban pressure to organic calmness. The cohesive use of color, geometry, and typographic hierarchy helps reinforce the emotional journey.

G. Reflection

This project strengthened my understanding of Swiss Style communication, particularly how abstraction can express emotion without relying on literal imagery. With more time, I would explore motion graphics to animate the transition from concrete to calm.